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Perhaps the hardest letter to write to my colleagues at the RBI was a letter informing them that I would be leaving at the end of my term. It is probably fitting to end the pieces on my term at the RBI with that letter, written on 18 June 2016. I wanted to reflect on how much we had accomplished together, even while promising a flurry of activity to tie up loose ends in the few months I had left.

Message to RBI Staff

Dear Colleagues,

I took office in September 2013 as the 23rd Governor of the Reserve Bank of India. At that time, the currency was plunging daily, inflation was high, and growth was weak. India was then deemed one of the 'Fragile Five'. In my opening statement as Governor, I laid out an agenda for action that I had discussed with you. By implementing these measures, I said we would 'build a bridge to the future, over the stormy waves produced by global financial markets'.

Today, I feel proud that we at the Reserve Bank have delivered on all these proposals. A new inflation-focused framework is in place that has helped halve inflation and allowed savers to earn positive real interest rates on deposits after a long time. We have also been able to cut interest rates by 150 basis points after raising them initially. This has reduced the nominal interest rate the government has to pay even while lengthening maturities it can issue – the government has been able to issue a forty-year bond for the first time. Finally, the currency stabilized after our actions, and our foreign exchange reserves are at a record high, even after we have fully provided for the outflow of foreign currency deposits we secured in 2013. Today, we are the